

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

World Vision scales up support for children and families affected by South Mindanao earthquake as severe weather compounds risks

GENERAL SANTOS CITY, Philippines - World Vision is intensifying its emergency response for children and families affected by the magnitude 7.8 earthquake that struck offshore Maasim, Sarangani on 8 June 2026, as continuing aftershocks, rains, and thunderstorms further threaten already vulnerable communities across Southern Mindanao.

According to the Philippine Institute of Volcanology and Seismology (PHIVOLCS), the earthquake, generated by the Cotabato Trench, caused intense shaking across the Zamboanga Peninsula, Davao Region, SOCCSKSARGEN, and the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). The disaster damaged homes, schools, infrastructure, water and sanitation facilities, and other essential services.

As of 26 June, the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) reported that 383,080 families or 1,636,796 persons, across 641 barangays in Regions IX, XI, XII, and BARMM had been affected by the earthquake and its aftershocks. More than 9,300 aftershocks have been recorded across Southern Mindanao, adding to fear and uncertainty among children and families.

The situation is further compounded by the southwest monsoon enhanced by Super Typhoon Francisco, which continues to bring rain and thunderstorms to parts of Mindanao. Landslide risks remain a serious concern, particularly in affected areas of Sarangani and Davao Occidental.

World Vision warns that children remain among the most vulnerable as risks continue to escalate.

“Children are among the hardest hit by this emergency. Many are living with fear, displacement, interrupted schooling, and uncertainty about what will happen next,” said Dr. Harvey Carpio, National Director of World Vision Philippines.

“Families urgently need food, clean water, shelter, hygiene supplies, and psychosocial support. We are working with communities and partners to help restore safety, stability, and hope,” Dr. Carpio shared.

Highlighting the impact on livelihoods, World Vision Program Officer for ADP North Cotabato Rex Rubio emphasized the challenges faced by farming communities.

“In Mindanao, earthquakes and typhoons hit farming communities hardest: damaged crops destroy families’ primary source of income, while limited livelihood alternatives make it difficult to repair homes and recover,” shared Rubio.

“With hundreds of hectares of farmland affected by the Southern Mindanao earthquake, LGUs are prioritizing early recovery and sustainable livelihood options so families can rebuild sooner, and children can return to school,” Rubio added.

Within eight hours of the earthquake, World Vision deployed its staff to General Santos City to conduct rapid needs assessments and activate emergency preparedness measures.

World Vision is responding in General Santos City and Sarangani Province, with the aim of reaching at least 4,000 families, or around 16,000 individuals. The response covers shelter, non-food items, food security and livelihoods, health, water, sanitation and hygiene, education, and child protection.

To date, World Vision has distributed 728 sleeping kits to households in General Santos City, and Sarangani. The organization has also established a Child-Friendly Space (CFS) in General Santos City, Sultan Kudarat and Sarangani where a total of 550 children have participated in play, art, emotional recovery activities, and received letters of encouragement from students in Thailand.

World Vision has conducted emotional coping sessions for 70 teaching and non-teaching personnel in General Santos City, as well as Psychological First Aid sessions for 38 non-teaching staff and school nurses in one of the schools in Sarangani.

Emergency needs remain urgent. Families require shelter and repair kits, safe water, hygiene and dignity kits, food and non-food assistance, temporary learning spaces, school supplies, psychosocial support, and essential medical services.

World Vision has deployed a National Rapid Response Team and strengthened safeguarding, security monitoring, and data protection measures to ensure that assistance reaches children and families safely and responsibly.

World Vision calls on government, humanitarian partners, donors, and the private sector to help scale up support for affected communities and ensure that children and families can recover with dignity.

With years of working alongside communities in Mindanao, World Vision remains committed to standing with children and families, protecting the most vulnerable, restoring lives, and making hope real.

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